missiles over Taiwan. A Chinese general warned the US that China was nuclear-armed and ready: 'So you [the US] are not going to threaten us again because you care a lot more about Los Angeles than Taipei.'[31] The US responded by sending two aircraft carrier battle-groups to the Taiwan Strait.

India's nuclear tests and India–US tensions

The end of the Cold War had vindicated the Indian view that the rivalry between the Soviet and American blocs was not immutable and statesmanship could end it. Having said that, India, allied to the Soviets, had come out on the losing side of the Cold War. On the other hand, China and Pakistan had come out on the winning side as partners of triumphant America. Worse, the post–Cold War period brought India's human rights record in Kashmir, Punjab, and Assam into full international view. Its closed economy was an anomaly in a world where the market increasingly ruled, and in 1991 its foreign exchange reserves fell so low it almost defaulted on its external bills. Finally, its nuclear programme was under scrutiny and pressure from the US and other non-proliferation crusaders as never before. For its part, Delhi was uncomfortable with the Comprehensive Test Ban Treaty (CTBT) despite having co-sponsored the negotiations in the UN. It was annoyed at Washington's insistence that the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) should be permanently extended. And it resented the US attempts to put it and Islamabad in the category of irresponsible nuclear states.

India's nuclear tests, followed by Pakistan's, led to a rough patch with Washington. According to US law, sanctions, an aid cut-off, and the termination of military supplies were mandatory American responses to nuclear proliferation. The US also piloted a unanimous UN Security Council resolution condemning the tests and asking India and Pakistan to stop their nuclear weapons programmes. The resolution urged them to join the NPT and the CTBT, to act with restraint, and, in a sting for India, to address the 'root causes' of their tensions, including Kashmir. As with